

LOLA THOMAS

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Growth and martech professional with an engineering background, leading the AI Paywall workstream on secondment at the Financial Times. Experience across 10+ clients, managing up to four projects simultaneously, combining people management, product roadmaps and technical expertise to drive consumer growth.

CORE EXPERTISE

Strategy & leadership: Growth strategy, people management, product roadmaps, client leadership & vendor selection

Marketing & growth: Owned, earned & paid channel strategy, lifecycle optimisation, proposition & conversion testing

Technical & analytical: Martech integrations, AI evaluation, HTML, CSS and JS builds, LTV modelling, forecasting & measurement

EXPERIENCE

In Digital Marketing | Manager, Experimentation & Analytics

JAN 2024 – PRESENT

Agency role covering strategy, analytics, experimentation, lifecycle optimisation and tech stack selection, implementation and management

Financial Times (Secondment) | Performance Optimisation Manager

- **Lead strategy and commercial performance** for the AI Paywall, which generated **£1M+ in incremental revenue** in 2025, aligning experimentation with subscriber growth and LTV.
- Act as **trading representative** across the paywall and storefront streams, tracking performance against commercial goals and identifying growth opportunities
- Partner with Product, Performance Marketing, CRM, Data Science and BI to align **lifecycle optimisation and measurement frameworks** with commercial priorities and revenue goals.
- **Build performance reporting and forecasts in Amplitude and Looker**; evaluate AI model inputs and behaviour to support model stability and commercial performance
- Represented Experimentation in the FT's Younger Audience initiative, **shaping strategies to increase social-to-web engagement, habituality and subscriber growth**.

In Digital (Agency) | Core Role

- Manage two direct reports, setting goals, delegating work and supporting development opportunities, upskilling and client relationship skills. Have served as the sole agency representative on client accounts, owning communications, delivery and relationships
- **Own product roadmaps** for marketing teams, built and integrated experimentation and product roadmap to manage sprints, timelines and forecasts against conversion targets
- **Lead experimentation across B2C acquisition and subscription journeys**, building and implementing tests using **HTML, CSS and Javascript**. Delivered a **36% conversion uplift** for The Independent when optimising their subscription funnel
- **Led a subscription/paywall platform RFP**, aligning requirements across marketing, analytics, engineering, commercial teams and VPs; managed vendor evaluation and selection
- Provide **technical support** across client accounts and internally, helping teams with martech integrations, tracking and platform troubleshooting
- Helped shape News UK AI Paywall strategy, evaluation and rollout planning. Help build an **experimentation agent and support colleagues in adopting AI bots for everyday work**.
- **Build LTV and product-mix models** to assess registration and advertising trade-offs alongside measurement frameworks that guide marketing and investment decisions
- **Awarded Best Use of Data** (Marketing Awards 2025) for contribution to Financial Times first-party data and experimentation strategy.

Smartology | Account Manager

JAN 2023 – JAN 2024

- **Managed programmatic display campaigns** across multiple industries, acting as a trusted strategic partner to senior clients; translated CPC, CTR and STR data via Google Analytics and Grafana into recommendations that improved ROI.

EDUCATION

University of Nottingham

SEP 2019 – JUN 2022

Bachelor of Engineering (Chemical Engineering) | Second-class honours, upper division (2:1)

Mill Hill County High School

SEP 2017 – JUN 2019

A Level | AAB in Mathematics, Chemistry and English Literature respectively